

EXPENSE REIMBURSEMENT

The purpose of the Loudoun County Public Schools (LCPS) Expense Reimbursement Regulation is to provide standards and guidelines that ensure compliance with applicable federal and state laws for all business expenses while maintaining necessary controls, accountability, and administrative efficiency.

Payment and reimbursement occur only for business expenses that are reasonable and necessary to accomplish LCPS business. Business expenses and reimbursements are public records subject to release under the Virginia Freedom of Information Act and must withstand the test of public review.

A. General Guidelines.

1. This Regulation applies to all LCPS employees and all public funds entrusted to LCPS. All funds managed by LCPS are public funds, regardless of their source of origin.
2. Each employee must exercise sound and prudent judgment when arranging for, incurring, and approving business expenses in accordance with this Regulation.
3. Sufficient funds for business expenses must be available within the respective program's budget.
4. Each employee must keep and submit detailed receipts for items totaling ten dollars (\$10.00) or more for which they intend to seek reimbursement, excluding Meals and Incidental Expenses (M&IE) and mileage.
5. Reimbursement requests must be submitted and approved through Oracle iExpense by the 7th of the month after the expense occurred.
 - a. Approved expenses include business travel for conferences, training sessions, seminars, mileage, and expenses to enhance teaching and learning experiences.
 - b. Any reimbursement requests not submitted by the deadline will become the responsibility of the employee.
 - c. Holding multiple months of expenses for a single larger reimbursement is not allowed.
 - d. An employee may not approve their own travel or expense reimbursement.
6. Expense and Travel Reimbursement information is located on the LCPS Intranet under the Financial Resource Center (FRC).

B. Definitions.

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1. Program. Any department, division, school, or other organization within LCPS.
2. Account Manager/Designee. An account manager is an officially appointed individual who directs and is responsible for a program's fiscal management. A designee is any person authorized to act on behalf of the account manager.
3. Home Worksite Location. School or office where the employee regularly performs their duties, as determined by their supervisor.
4. Itinerant. An employee who is required to travel to multiple locations to perform their job duties.
5. Daily Commuting Mileage. Mileage between the employee's residence and Home Worksite Location (roundtrip) incurred on a contracted workday. It is a personal expense and is not reimbursable.
6. Business Meals & Incidental Expenses (M&IE). Business meals, gratuities, and tips given to porters, baggage carriers, and hotel staff. Reimbursement is provided on a per diem basis to employees engaged in non-local business travel as an allowance for potential M&IE costs incurred. The per diem rate is based on current U.S. General Services Administration (GSA) rates for domestic travel. The first and last calendar days of travel are, by default, calculated at seventy-five percent (75%) of the GSA rate for domestic travel.
7. Local Business Travel. Travel that is less than fifty (50) miles from the Home Worksite Location. Overnight lodging is not authorized and the M&IE allowance is not provided for local business travel.
8. Non-local Business Travel. Travel that is more than fifty (50) miles from the Home Worksite Location or outside of Virginia.
9. LCPS Purchase Card (PCard). The PCard is the payment method for all business expenses, excluding non-local M&IE. PCard numbers are not allowed to be stored on any vendor website or payment portal (e.g., Uber).

C. Expenses.

1. Reimbursable Expenses.
 - a. M&IE Reimbursements.
 - (i) Local Business Meals. An allowable business expense that is considered reasonable and necessary to the furtherance of the LCPS mission, core values, and goals. The conduct of LCPS business must be a significant and substantial purpose of the time spent during the business meal.

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- (a) Business meals will be paid at cost (including tax and gratuity) up to the prevailing GSA rate for the corresponding meal type (i.e., breakfast, lunch, or dinner).
 - (b) Costs above the GSA rate will only be allowed with prior written approval from the supervisor and the account manager or designee.
 - (c) The preferred payment method is LCPS PCard. If a PCard is not available, an employee may seek reimbursement through Oracle iExpense.
- b. Mileage Reimbursement. GSA rates dictate what will be reimbursed. This reimbursement covers various factors, including the cost of fuel, depreciation, maintenance, insurance, and taxes.
 - (i) Personal Vehicle. If an employee chooses to use a personal vehicle for conducting LCPS business, it is the employee's responsibility to ensure any adequate insurance coverage is provided by their personal automobile insurance company and possess a valid driver's license issued within the United States.
 - (ii) Local Business Travel Mileage Reimbursement. Business mileage is reimbursable only to the extent that the mileage incurred exceeds the employee's daily commuting mileage. The rate of reimbursement is on a per-mile driven basis and is equal to the rate established by the GSA, found on the [FRC](#).
 - (a) Allowable Mileage. Employees should use the "Allowable Mileage Chart" ([Transportation Site](#)) to determine the mileage between destinations and reduce it by the daily commuting mileage.
 - (1) Mileage to an alternate location is permissible if it exceeds the employee's daily commuting mileage.
 - (2) When an employee is required to work outside of their contracted hours and uses their personal vehicle to respond to work, mileage is reimbursable for the full distance.
 - (3) Mileage on a non-contracted day is reimbursable for the full distance.
 - (b) Employees with a vehicle allowance qualify for mileage reimbursement for travel outside of the County, or may use an LCPS pool vehicle.

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(iii) Non-local Business Travel Mileage Reimbursement.

(a) Allowable Mileage. The reimbursement rate is per-mile driven and equal to the rate established by the GSA, found on the [FRC](#).

- (1) Travel involving overnight stays does not require the daily commuting mileage reduction.
- (2) If the employee is driven to an airport or other commercial transportation by another person, the round-trip mileage will be reimbursed.

c. Parking. Parking fees paid at airports, lodging facilities, and other locations for the duration of business travel are reimbursable.

d. Tolls. Toll fees paid for the duration of business travel. Toll fees incurred during business travel are eligible for reimbursement if their use is justified as necessary and provides reasonable expediency.

e. Public Transportation. Subway, Metrorail, Bus, Ferry, and Shuttle or Rideshare services (e.g., Uber, Lyft, taxi, etc.) are permitted, reimbursable transportation options.

f. Miscellaneous. Telephone calls, Internet access (Wi-Fi), fax transmissions, printing, hotel resort fees, etc.

g. Other Business-Related Expense Reimbursements. Reimbursement requests for other business-related expenses that are not associated with travel and cannot be purchased with a PCard, (e.g., notary application fees) will be reimbursed if the supervisor and account manager or designee's approval has been obtained in advance.

2. Non-reimbursable Expenses.

- a. Expenses for family members or companions, non-business or leisure travel and excursions, expenses for personal entertainment, fees for athletic or exercise facilities, golf or tennis fees, and alcoholic beverage costs are not reimbursable.
- b. An employee who does not attend a meeting, conference, continuing or professional education, exam sitting, workshop, seminar/training, or convention and who does not cancel in time to obtain a refund shall be responsible for reimbursing LCPS unless the cancellation is due to unexpected circumstances and approved by their supervisor and account manager or designee.

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- c. If an employee voluntarily chooses to travel earlier or stay longer than required and with supervisor and account manager or designee approval, they will not be reimbursed for any additional costs unless the change reduces the total trip cost.
 - (i) Employees must provide official documentation detailing the cost variance between the business travel itinerary and the itinerary incorporating non-business travel.
- d. If personal days are incorporated into the business travel schedule, the appropriate leave must be used.

D. Non-Local Business Travel Processes.

1. Travel Request. A travel request form is required for all estimated pre-travel business expenses, except when reimbursement is for mileage only. Employees must submit a Travel Request Form to their supervisor and account manager or designee for approval at least thirty (30) days before proposed travel. The employee's name at the bottom of the form certifies the accuracy of all information and the legitimacy of the travel. Approval signatures certify that funds are available and that the travel is necessary and approved. Below outlines each section of the travel request form, which should be completed, (if applicable) for the Non-Local Business Travel.

- a. M&IE.
 - (i) A monetary advance at the GSA allowable rate for the location can be requested in Oracle iExpense three (3) to ten (10) business days before travel.
 - (ii) If travel time is required the day before or after the event, the employee will be reimbursed for the additional M&IE.
- b. Lodging. Refer to GSA Travel Resources to determine the allowable rate per location, with the exception of host hotels. All expenses must be necessary and reasonable; exceptions may apply with the supervisor and account manager or designee approval.
 - (i) The event must be fifty (50) miles or greater from the Home Worksite Location or outside of Virginia.
 - (ii) With the supervisor and account manager or designee approval, employees may be permitted to travel one (1) day before and one (1) day after the event.

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- (iii) It is at the discretion of the supervisor and the account manager or designee to approve a rate higher than the GSA lodging rate.
- c. Registration. An expense for a meeting, conference, continuing or professional education, exam sitting, workshop, seminar/training, or convention.
- d. Airline/Train/Bus.
 - (i) The lowest non-refundable standard coach rate is allowed for airline reservations.
 - (ii) The lowest standard coach rate or express rail is allowed for train reservations.
 - (iii) Bus travel is permitted instead of automobile, airline, or rail transportation when cost-beneficial and feasible.
 - (iv) It is at the discretion of the supervisor and the account manager or designee as to allowable upgrade fees, and these must be included on the Travel Request Form.
 - (v) Checked Baggage. One (1) checked bag will be an approved expense for each direction of travel. Charges for oversized or overweight baggage shall be the responsibility of the employee. The supervisor and account manager or designee may make an exception for these charges based on the length of travel, destination, special materials, equipment, etc., as required for the business travel.
- e. Rental Vehicle. Reservations must be made through the contracted LCPS vendor, whose information is available in the [Financial Resource Center](#).
 - (i) Rental of fifteen (15) passenger vans is prohibited.
 - (ii) Commercial rental vehicles as a primary mode of transportation at the travel destination may be authorized only if the rental vehicle is more economical than any other type of public transportation, or if the destination is not otherwise accessible.
 - (iii) Rental vehicle insurance offered by the rental agency should be declined for any rental vehicles driven by a LCPS employee.

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- (iv) Vehicle rental is permitted instead of airline, train, or bus transportation to the travel destination when feasible and cost-beneficial. The employee must possess a valid driver's license issued within the United States. When driving a rented vehicle for business travel, all LCPS policies and regulations apply. Employees shall not use tobacco, alcohol, or drugs while operating a rented vehicle.

2. Travel Reimbursement and Reconciliation.

- a. [Travel Reconciliation Form](#). A Travel Reconciliation Form is required when a Travel Request Form was submitted prior to travel. The Travel Reconciliation Form calculates the difference between pre-approved estimated expenses and actual post-travel expenses.
- b. A Travel Reconciliation Form must be attached to the Oracle iExpense.
- c. Travel expenses submitted without detailed receipts will not be accepted and will become the employee's responsibility.

3. Travel Cancellation.

- a. If the travel/event has been canceled for any reason other than the fault of the employee, a refund to the PCard must be requested.
- b. M&IE received prior to a canceled travel/event (regardless of who canceled) must be reimbursed to LCPS within five (5) business days.

Adopted: 5/17/21, 11/28/23, 07/1/24
Current Revision: 07/28/25

Cross Refs: [Policy 7550, Drug-And-Alcohol Free Workplace](#), [Policy 7552, Tobacco-And-Smoke-Free Environment](#)